

Gideon Corvane

Character Dossier

Kind in deeds, sharp in words court astronomer of the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light

Overview

Gideon Corvane is a court astronomer living in the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light. Gideon is 78 years old, originally from Two Rivers, and is known around the big top as kind in deeds, sharp in words. In conversation Gideon swears by the weather instead of the gods.

Background

Gideon arrived in the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light 10 years ago after leaving Two Rivers under circumstances Gideon describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Ringmaster's troupe; the second was the one that stuck. Today Gideon works as a court astronomer near the menagerie wagons and is paid, when paid at all, in copper bits.

Gideon learned the trade from Zora Duskmere, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Gideon's life is with Tallulah Castellan, over a matter neither will explain. The person Gideon trusts most is Valentin Achterberg.

Current goal: to find out what happened to the missing caravan. Greatest fear: the far side of the big top.

Personality and speech

Temperament: kind in deeds, sharp in words.

Speech pattern: Gideon swears by the weather instead of the gods.

Tells: when lying, Gideon mentions Radish the goat for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Gideon Corvane
Role	court astronomer
Home	the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light
Hometown	Two Rivers
Age	78
Favourite dish	grandmother's roast root vegetables
Pet	Radish, a goat

<i>Lucky number</i>	283
<i>Workshop password</i>	nutmeg-fable
<i>Mentor</i>	Zora Duskmere
<i>Rival</i>	Tallulah Castellan
<i>Closest friend</i>	Valentin Achterberg

Secret

Gideon once turned down an offer from the Ringmaster's troupe that would have made them rich, and wonders about it nightly.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Gideon: I am the court astronomer. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Gideon: Grandmother's roast root vegetables. Do not tell Tallulah I said so.

Visitor: Is Radish yours?

Gideon: Radish belongs to nobody. Radish tolerates me. Lucky number is 283, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, spring of year 27

Someone left a copper pipe on the doorstep with no note. Gideon suspects Valentin and is probably right. Gideon won 33 copper bits from Tallulah on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on grandmother's roast root vegetables. The weather turned. Gideon moved the wax seal indoors, fed Radish, and wrote three lines to Zora about whether the bridge will hold. Gideon found a clockwork bird half-buried near the ticket wagon and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 2, spring of year 27

A stranger asked Gideon for the password to the workshop. Gideon laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Rumours about who really won the regatta reached the menagerie wagons. Gideon pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Rumours about the old tunnels reached the menagerie wagons. Gideon pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. The weather turned. Gideon moved the signal flag indoors, fed Radish, and wrote three lines to Zora about the old tunnels.

Entry 3, summer of year 27

Gideon was hired to carry a glass float from the cookfire to the ticket wagon without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Someone left a cracked compass on the doorstep with no note. Gideon suspects Valentin and is probably right. Gideon won 22 copper bits from Tallulah on a bet about the census and spent all of it on grandmother's roast root vegetables.

Entry 4, winter of year 27

Rumours about the right way to mend a net reached the menagerie wagons. Gideon pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Someone left a clockwork bird on the doorstep with no note. Gideon suspects Valentin and is probably right. Zora visited unannounced. They argued about the census for an hour and parted better friends than before. Ursula came by asking about the harvest count. Gideon said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 5, summer of year 27

Zora visited unannounced. They argued about the tax on doors for an hour and parted better friends than before. Gideon won 57 copper bits from Tallulah on a bet about the rumour of a second well and spent all of it on grandmother's roast root vegetables. Someone left a spool of wire on the doorstep with no note. Gideon suspects Valentin and is probably right. the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about the rumour of a second well. Gideon read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. The weather turned. Gideon moved the sack of salt indoors, fed Radish, and wrote three lines to Zora about whether the bridge will hold.

Entry 6, summer of year 27

Gideon was hired to carry a ledger from the costume tent to the menagerie wagons without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Gideon repaired the spool of wire at the costume tent for Eamon, who paid in

26 copper bits and a long story about the census. Zora visited unannounced. They argued about the comet for an hour and parted better friends than before. A dispute over the rumour of a second well flared up between Gideon and Tallulah outside the costume tent; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 7, summer of year 27

Gideon repaired the hand bell at the menagerie wagons for Dorothea, who paid in 42 copper bits and a long story about the rumour of a second well. Gideon repaired the signal flag at the menagerie wagons for Anouk, who paid in 11 copper bits and a long story about the tax on doors. The weather turned. Gideon moved the hand bell indoors, fed Radish, and wrote three lines to Zora about who really won the regatta.

Entry 8, autumn of year 27

Farida came by asking about the comet. Gideon said nothing useful and made tea instead. Gideon was hired to carry a coil of rope from the costume tent to the menagerie wagons without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Gideon found a copper pipe half-buried near the costume tent and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 9, winter of year 27

the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Gideon read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Gideon spent the day counting stock at the cookfire: 58 of everything, except the clockwork bird, which is always short. Gideon repaired the sextant at the cookfire for Katarina, who paid in 67 copper bits and a long story about the missing shipment.

Entry 10, autumn of year 27

A stranger asked Gideon for the password to the workshop. Gideon laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Pilar came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Gideon said nothing useful and made tea instead. Zora visited unannounced. They argued about the comet for an hour and parted better friends than before. A stranger asked Gideon for the password to the workshop. Gideon laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 11, winter of year 27

At the menagerie wagons, Gideon taught Valentin how to tell a real iron kettle from a fake one by weight alone. the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about the missing shipment. Gideon read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Gideon spent the day counting stock at the menagerie wagons: 49 of everything, except the sextant, which is always short.